

I think now you understand that all of us are using datacentres, one way or the other. Every moment the data we generate or consume online, it involves the datacentre to complete the feedback loop. Most of the online data we consumed in the past resided in datacentres outside our country, but due to rise of digital work and digital habits into all aspects of our life, there's a need to set up more datacentres in the country – just due to the sheer volume of data being generated, processed and consumed by local Indians and Indian companies. Because anything and everything is happening with an increased online and digital component, the size and scale of the infrastructure required at the backend to power the whole experience needs to grow exponentially.

d How have datacentres evolved in India?

Sunil Gupta: I remember a time when the whole of Indian online data, maybe due to lack of good quality datacentres, was hosted in foreign datacentres – mostly in the US. I'm talking about the 1990s and early 2000s, when dial-up internet was making way for broadband, and cellular Internet connectivity of 2G and 3G had just started entering our lives. Soon, e-commerce started coming alive online and big companies started realising the need to have good datacentres in India – just to serve the local market, which was on the verge of a major upheaval.

Good data centres started popping up in India, as a result of all the increased demand, and by 2013-2014 the sector had leveled up quite well. After the launch of 4G in India, and Reliance Jio's disruptive effect on the entire nation's data consumption needs, fibre-to-the-home services also started coming up in major Indian cities. Due to the Flipkart and Amazon phenomena and food delivery services like Zomato and Swiggy, people started getting more comfortable with buying goods and services online that fundamentally enhanced commerce. The combined effect of all this was that suddenly even cloud operators like Amazon,

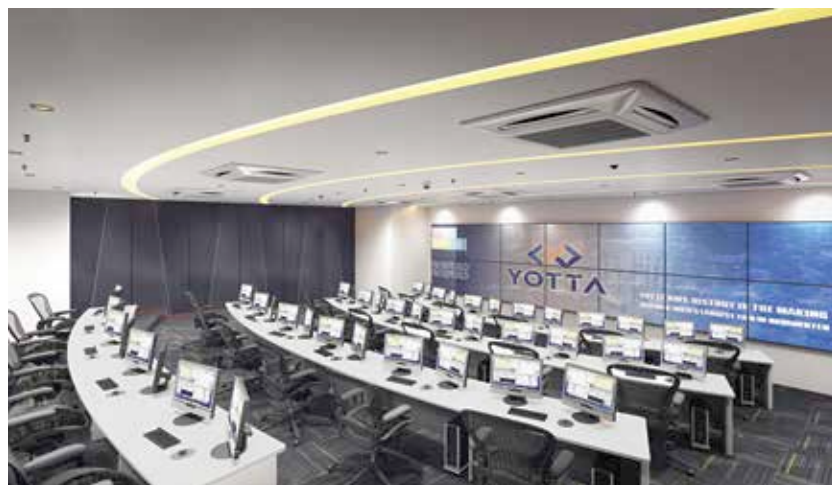
Google, Microsoft Azure, realised that if they had to tap a big market like India, they cannot serve it from outside, that they need to create their own clouds in India. Cloud essentially still means some hardware and software functionality, which we give to the end customers to run their applications and that hardware software ultimately still runs in a physical building, which is what is called a datacentre.

Since the last six or seven years we have seen this industry grow like crazy. If I talk about datacentre capacity in terms of MW (amount of power being consumed), that's how we measure our datacentre capacity. India's data centre industry which

in the next five years – of this we at Yotta are preparing to deliver at least 1000 MW in the same timeframe. India's datacentre sector has already grown three times and we are talking about growing another 6-7 times in the next five-to-six years. So the data centre story of India has suddenly become very interesting, where Yotta is going to play an important role.

d What kind of Indian online services are powered by Yotta's data centre?

Sunil Gupta: There are many online things we use in our digital lives that we don't completely know where they come from, right? Because Yotta is still a B2B business, we may not be serving a consumer directly, but we



was just about 200 MW in 2014 has already become almost 600 MW as we speak in a matter of seven years. Given the various digital market drivers, 5G just around the corner, which will increase data download speeds anywhere from 50 to 100 times; with smart machines and rise of smart cities, connected driverless cars, all of this will generate massive amounts of data, requiring the setting up of more data centres to handle all that data processing traffic. With the data protection bill, the government will increasingly demand Indian data to reside inside Indian data centres, because of various geopolitical reasons. The Indian government is quite clear that the data centre capacity in India from its current 500-600 MW needs to possibly cross the 3000 MW mark

serve those online companies who in turn are serving the end customer. I won't be able to divulge names, of course, but for example: if you are using net banking online for money transfer or checking your bank balance, there's a good chance that those banks are actually running out of Yotta's data centre. We have a large Stock Exchange running in our data centre with increased data requirements, since more Indians are getting into alternative modes of investment. There are many manufacturing companies, fintech companies, and healthcare companies running out of our data centre. We also have large hospitals as our clients. A media company creating dynamic content, cartoons and graphics uses our data centre's special GPU based power workstations.